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ANTENNA DEVICE, FWA COMMUNICATION SYSTEM WITH ANTENNA DEVICE, AND METHOD FOR FWA COMMUNICATION

Abstract

A system that comprises an antenna device that includes a plurality of passive patch antennas on a planar substrate and a movable frame that supports the planar substrate. The plurality of passive patch antennas is detachably coupled to a plurality of external antenna ports of a customer premise equipment (CPE). The system includes a processor that controls the CPE to switch connection of a modem of the CPE from one or more inbuilt antennas of the CPE to the plurality of passive patch antennas. The processor controls, based on an instruction from the CPE over an out-of-band control link, the movement of the movable frame to different three-dimensional (3D) position coordinates.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS/INCORPORATION BY REFERENCE

[0001] This Application makes reference to, claims priority to, and claims benefit from and is a Continuation Application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/747,754, filed on Jun. 19, 2024, which is a Continuation Application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/329,923, filed on Jun. 6, 2023, now U.S. Pat. No. 12,082,001, which claims priority from U.S. Provisional Application Ser. No. 63/427,055 filed on Nov. 21, 2022. The above-referenced Application is hereby incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

FIELD OF TECHNOLOGY

[0002] Certain embodiments of the disclosure relate to remote antenna and fixed wireless access (FWA) communication systems. More specifically, certain embodiments of the disclosure relate to an antenna device, a fixed wireless access (FWA) communication system with the antenna device, and a method for FWA communication for high performance wireless communication.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Typically, users near the edge of the cell in cellular networks often suffer from low signal-to-interference-plus-noise ratio (SINR) levels due to being far away from the base station. The cell-edge problem in cellular networks refers to the issue of poor signal quality and low data rates experienced by users located at the edge of the cell. This problem arises due to weak signal strength caused by distance-dependent path loss and multipath fading. It may not always be a feasible solution to increase the base station transmit power as it can lead to increased inter-cell interference.

[0004] Although many fixed wireless access (FWA) systems have been around for quite some time, currently, the conventional FWA systems are unable to provide the data speeds needed to compete with wired broadband connections. The next generation of 5G or 6G-based fixed wireless technology is expected to hit data rates in the order of several Gbps. The 5G FWA connections are expected to grow exponentially globally over the next decade, resulting in multifold traffic growth. However, there are many open technical challenges for a successful and practical use of the 5G FWA or the upcoming 6G FWA. In a first example, one of the most prominent technical issues is how to achieve cell center like performance even in the cell edge areas using FWA systems (e.g., a customer premise equipment (CPE)) without increasing the telecommunications infrastructure cost. Currently, conventional CPE performance becomes significantly degraded as the distance from the cellular signal source (e.g., the base station or a small cell) increases, for example, at the cell edge areas. In a second example, Quality of experience (QoE) is another open issue, which is a measure of a user's holistic satisfaction level with a service provider (e.g., Internet access, video streaming, or other carrier network-enabled services). The challenge is how to ensure a seamless connectivity as well as QoE without significantly increasing infrastructure cost, which may be commercially unsustainable with present solutions. In indoor scenarios, like a home or an enterprise, poor signal strength from a wireless network can make surfing the internet and downloading or uploading content a frustrating experience. Furthermore, the number of wireless sensors and IoT devices are rapidly increasing with the increase in smart homes, smart offices, enterprises, etc. Existing communication systems are unable to handle such massive number of wireless sensors and IoT

devices and their quality-of-service (QOS) requirements. In such cases, it is extremely difficult and technically challenging to support these end user devices for high-speed low latency applications. Thus, the inbuilt antennas of the conventional CPEs suffer from inconsistent performance in terms of data throughput and signal quality provided to its connected users, which aggravate in the cell edge areas.

[0005] Further limitations and disadvantages of conventional and traditional approaches will become apparent to one of skill in the art, through comparison of such systems with some aspects of the present disclosure as set forth in the remainder of the present application with reference to the drawings.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE DISCLOSURE

[0006] An antenna device, a fixed wireless access (FWA) communication system with the antenna device, and a method for FWA communication for high performance wireless communication, substantially as shown in and/or described in connection with at least one of the figures, as set forth more completely in the claims.

[0007] These and other advantages, aspects, and novel features of the present disclosure, as well as details of an illustrated embodiment thereof, will be more fully understood from the following description and drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

[0008] FIG. 1A is a diagram illustrating an exemplary fixed wireless access (FWA) communication system with a customer premise equipment (CPE) and an antenna device, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure.

[0009] FIG. 1B is a diagram illustrating an exemplary fixed wireless access (FWA) communication system with a customer premise equipment (CPE) and an antenna device, in accordance with another exemplary embodiment of the disclosure.

[0010] FIG. 2A is a block diagram that illustrates various components of an exemplary antenna device, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure.

[0011] FIG. 2B is a diagram illustrating a perspective view of the antenna device of FIG. 2A along with an unmounted planar substrate, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure.

[0012] FIG. 2C is a diagram illustrating a perspective view of the antenna device of FIG. 2A with mounted planar substrate along with patch antennas, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure.

[0013] FIG. 2D is a diagram illustrating a perspective view of the antenna device of FIG. 2A, in accordance with another exemplary embodiment of the disclosure.

[0014] FIG. 3 is a block diagram that illustrates various components of an exemplary central cloud server, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure.

[0015] FIG. 4 is a method that illustrates an exemplary method for FWA communication for high performance wireless communication, in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0016] FIGS. 5A, 5B, and 5C collectively illustrate a flowchart illustrating an exemplary method for FWA communication for high performance wireless communication, in accordance with another embodiment of the disclosure.

[0017] FIG. 6 is a diagram of an exemplary scenario depicting performance of a CPE at different locations around a defined physical area with and without the antenna device, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0018] FIG. 7 is a diagram of an exemplary scenario of a repeater device with an integrated antenna device, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE DISCLOSURE

[0019] Certain embodiments of the disclosure may be found in an antenna device, a fixed wireless access (FWA) communication system with the antenna device, and a method for FWA communication for high performance wireless communication. The antenna device and method of the present disclosure significantly improves the performance of a customer premise equipment (CPE). The antenna device of the present disclosure establishes an out-of-band control link with the CPE and controls a movement of a plurality of passive patch antennas of the antenna device in a specific three-dimensional (3D) position coordinate at a given time-of-day such that a radio frequency (RF) signal receptivity by one or more passive patch antennas of the plurality of passive patch antennas is significantly increased. The antenna device overcomes scanning loss, signal attenuating or blocking obstacles, bring street side signal indoors, and significantly enhance personal hotspots in indoor area. The antenna device is a universal remote antenna that can be detachably attached to any CPE of any manufacturer in a Snap-On configuration, which then increases the performance of the CPE even if the CPE is in a cell edge area. In other words, users in the cell edge areas can have cell centre like performance when the antenna device is plugged with the CPE. In the following description, reference is made to the accompanying drawings, which form a part hereof, and in which is shown, by way of illustration, various embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0020] FIG. 1A is a diagram illustrating an exemplary fixed wireless access (FWA) communication system with a customer premise equipment (CPE) and an antenna device, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure. With reference to FIG. 1A, there is shown a FWA communication system **100A** that may include an antenna device **102** and a customer premise equipment (CPE) **104**. In an implementation, FWA communication system **100A** may further include a central cloud server **106**. There is further shown a radio access network (RAN) node **106** (e.g., a base station or a small cell) and one or more user equipment (UEs) **110**. In an implementation, the CPE **104** may include one or more inbuilt antennas **104A**, and one or more processors **104B**, and a modem **104C**.

[0021] The antenna device **102** is designed and developed to be detachably coupled to the CPE **104** in a Snap-On configuration, i.e., the antenna device **102** is configured to be attached or detached quickly and easily with any CPE, such as the CPE **104**. Alternatively, in another implementation, the antenna device **102** (i.e., the external antenna) may be connected to the CPE **104** (e.g., a CPE box) via short cables. The antenna device **102** may be a smart universal remote antenna, which can be plugged to any CPE of any manufacturer providing a cost-effective and significant performance improvement for CPEs, such as the CPE **104** (improves signal quality significantly up to 7 times in certain locations) as compared to conventional FWA devices and systems. In one implementation, the antenna device **102** may be configured to operate in C-band frequencies (e.g., 4-8 GHz or 3.7-4.2 GHz) for 5G NR communication. In another implementation, the antenna device **102** may be multiband antenna device, which may operate in different frequencies band as per use case, for example, the antenna device **102** may be a XG-enabled remote antenna device, where XG refers to 5G or 6G radio communication.

[0022] The CPE **104** may be a 5G or 6G CPE that may connect several end-user devices at the same time, such as the one or more UEs **110**, to the Internet through receiving RF signals (e.g., 5G signals in C-band) of a service provider (a mobile network operator or a wireless carrier network) communicated by the RAN node **108** (e.g., 5G base station) and then transferring those RF signals (e.g. 5G signals) into wireless local area network signals (e.g., Wi-Fi®) signals). In an implementation, there may be a subscriber identity module (SIM) inserted in the CPE **104** to subscribe a particular carrier network. Examples of the CPE **104** may include, but are not limited to an Internet gateway device, a CPE, or any piece of connected telecommunication equipment that is used for accessing the Internet or generally accessing services on a provider network, whether directly or indirectly connected to that carrier or cellular network that is placed on the customer

side of the network and can be a demarcation point between the service provider network (WAN) and the customer's home network or LAN, or any customer premise equipment.

[0023] In the present disclosure, the CPE **104** may be communicatively coupled to the central cloud server **106**. In an implementation, the one or more inbuilt antennas **104A** (i.e., internal antennas) of the CPE **104** may be bypassed when the antenna device **102** is detachably coupled to the CPE **104** in the Snap-On configuration. In such a case, the modem **104C** of the CPE **104** may be disconnected from the inbuilt antennas **104A** (i.e., internal antennas) of the CPE **104** and may be communicatively coupled to a plurality of passive patch antennas of the antenna device **102**. The RF signals may be then received by the antenna device **102** and passed to the CPE **104**. The modem **104C** of the CPE **104** may be configured to perform usual modem functions, for example, modulation and demodulation, cellular connection management, error correction, user's data security, and network traffic management. In some implementations, in a case where the antenna device **102** and the CPE **104** is developed by the same manufacturer, the one or more inbuilt antennas **104A** may be kept for back-up purpose or may be removed. The one or more processors **104B** may be coprocessors, a combination of an application processor and a modem processor (an example is shown in FIG. 1B in an example), or other signal processors or control circuits. The CPE **104** may be an outdoor 5G-enabled CPE or an indoor 5G-enabled CPE.

[0024] The central cloud server **106** includes suitable logic, circuitry, and interfaces that may be configured to communicate with a plurality of CPEs, such as the CPE **104**. In some implementation, the central cloud server **106** may directly communicate with the antenna device **102**. In an example, the central cloud server **106** may be a remote management server that is managed by a third party different from the service providers associated with a plurality of different wireless carrier networks. In another example, the central cloud server **106** may be a remote management server or a data center that is managed by a third party, or jointly managed, or managed in coordination and association with one or more of the plurality of different wireless carrier networks. In an implementation, the central cloud server **106** may be a master cloud server or a master machine that is a part of a data center that controls an array of other cloud servers communicatively coupled to it for load balancing, running customized applications, and efficient data management.

[0025] The RAN node **108** may be a base station (e.g., an eNB, a Master eNB (MeNB for non-standalone mode, or a gNB) or a 5G or 6G enabled small cell). The RAN node **108** may be a fixed point of communication that may communicate information, in the form of RF signals or beams of RF signals, to and from communication devices, such as the antenna device **102** (or the CPE **104** when the CPE **104** is not coupled to the antenna device **102**). Multiple base stations corresponding to one service provider may be geographically positioned to cover specific geographical areas.

[0026] Each of one or more UEs **110** may correspond to a telecommunication hardware used by an end-user to communicate. For example, each of the one or more UEs **106** may refer to a combination of a mobile equipment and subscriber identity module (SIM). Each of the one or more UEs **110** may be a subscriber of at least one of the plurality of different wireless carrier networks. Examples of the one or more UEs **106** may include, but are not limited to, a smartphone, a virtual reality headset, an augment reality device, a cable or satellite television set-top box, a VoIP station, or any other customized hardware for telecommunication.

[0027] In operation, the antenna device **102** may be detachably coupled to the CPE **104** in the Snap-On configuration. In an implementation, the one or more inbuilt antennas **104A** (i.e., internal antennas) of the CPE **104** may be bypassed when the antenna device **102** is detachably coupled to the CPE **104** in the Snap-On configuration. Alternatively, in another implementation, the antenna device **102** (i.e., the external antenna) may be connected to the CPE **104** (e.g., a CPE box) via short cables instead of the Snap-On configuration. The antenna device **102** may be configured to establish an out-of-band control link (e.g., a Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) link or other personal area network link) with the CPE **104**. The CPE **104** may be configured to communicate an

instruction to the antenna device **102** over the out-of-band control link. The antenna device **102** may be configured to align a plurality of passive patch antennas of the antenna device **102** in a specific three-dimensional (3D) position coordinate at a given time-of-day such that a radio frequency (RF) signal receptivity by one or more passive patch antennas of the plurality of passive patch antennas may be increased from a first signal state to a second signal state at a first location of the antenna device **102**. Further, the performance and service of the CPE **104** that may serve the one or more UEs **110** may be proportionally increased from a first throughput rate to a second throughput rate with the increase in the signal receptivity from the first signal state to the second signal state. The second signal state manifest improved signal quality parameters as compared to the first signal state. The signal state may refer to signal quality parameters of the received signal, such as signal strength in decibels, signal-to-noise ratio (SNR), signal-to-interference-plus-noise ratio (SINR), and data throughput rate. The antenna device **102** significantly increases the performance of the CPE **104** such that the CPE **104** becomes capable to achieve cell center like performance even in the cell edge areas without increasing any telecommunications infrastructure cost.

[0028] In the conventional systems, many UEs, such as the one or more UEs **110**, that are located beyond the communication range of the RAN node **108** or the UEs that suffer from inconsistent signal strength issues being in cell edge areas, either require additional infrastructure, such as dense deployment of small cells and conventional repeater devices to fill the coverage gaps in the cellular communication to enable multi-gigabit data communication or a wired broadband connection. However, such deployments increase the infrastructure cost (e.g., cost of deployment as well as maintenance), and still often the signal strength and data throughput vary throughout a day (i.e., signal fluctuations or data throughput rate fluctuations observed throughout a given 24-hours cycle in a day). It is observed during experimentation that the fluctuations or changes in signal quality at different times-of-day may be attributed to dynamic nature of the environment, e.g., any change in surroundings that has the potential to adversely impact signal propagation, cause signal loss, poor reach, or signal blockage by moving or stationary objects in surroundings. Further, a fluctuation (e.g., an increase or decrease) in the base station transmitting power at different times of day or a change in weather may further lead to fluctuations or changes in signal quality at different times of day. Furthermore, in certain scenarios, radiated RF beams from the RAN node **108** in different directions using the beam sweeping mechanism may be obstructed by one or more signal obstructing objects in a specific geographical area, for example, in and around a building. It is also observed that a change in radiation pattern of the RAN node **108** and a presence of reflective objects in the signal reception path may also contribute to the inconsistency of signal reception at a given location around a building. Currently, thus wired broadband connection is still preferred over fixed wireless access (FWA) systems and solutions, like a conventional CPE as conventional FWA systems are unable to provide the data speeds needed to compete with wired broadband connections.

[0029] In contrast to the conventional FWA systems, the FWA communication system **100A** of the present disclosure enables to improve signal quality and data throughput of the UEs, such as the one or more UEs **110**, by significantly improving the performance of the CPE **104** to which the one or more UEs **110** may be connected, while the need to deploy additional intermediate repeaters, small cells, or base stations. Instead of using inbuilt antennas of the CPE **104**, the antenna device **102** employs intelligent time-of-day driven automatic alignment of the plurality of passive patch antennas to improve quality of RF signals captured from the RAN node **110** (e.g., an existing base station or an existing small cell). This time-of-day driven automatic alignment of the plurality of passive patch antennas of the antenna device **102** is observed to significantly improve the data throughput rate and improve signal receptivity (i.e., signal strength of captured RF signals) in the 5G NR communication by many fold as compared to conventional CPE or conventional FWA systems. An exemplary comparison observed during experimentation of existing FWA systems,

such as a conventional CPE that uses inbuilt antenna versus the FWA system **100A** that employs the antenna device **102**, is shown and described, for example, in FIG. **6**. The antenna device **102** when coupled to the CPE **104** and when in operation achieves cell center like performance even in the cell edge areas without increasing the telecommunications infrastructure cost. Moreover, since the antenna device **102** employs passive patch antennas, the antenna device **102** may be a low-power device, which can be powered by a battery, used especially for alignment of the plurality of passive patch antennas of the antenna device **102** at certain times-of-day. Such automatic time-of-day specific alignment maintains a consistency of performance of the CPE **104** at different times of day for seamless connectivity of the one or more UEs **110** in indoor or outdoor scenarios connected to the CPE **104** over wireless signals (e.g., Wi-Fi® signals), thereby improving Quality of experience (QoE). Thus, the FWA communication system **100A** by virtue of the simplified Snap-On connection with the CPE **104** may transform the CPE **104** into a high performance FWA device that ensures consistent performance in terms of improved data throughput and improved signal quality provided to its connected users, even in the cell edge areas.

[0030] FIG. **1B** is a diagram illustrating an exemplary fixed wireless access (FWA) communication system with a customer premise equipment (CPE) and an antenna device, in accordance with another exemplary embodiment of the disclosure. With reference to FIG. **1B**, there is shown a FWA communication system **100B** that may include the antenna device **102** and the CPE **104**, which may further include a plurality of external antenna ports **112**, a remote antenna driver **114**, and one or more processors, such as an application processor **116A** and a modem processor **116B**. The application processor **116A** and the modem processor **116B** may correspond to the one or more processors **104B** of FIG. **1A**.

[0031] In operation, a site survey of an environment around a physical area, such as around a building (e.g., an enterprise or a home), may be conducted. The site survey may be conducted using a smartphone, such as the UE **110A**, and a heatmap may be generated for different locations around the building. The heatmap may indicate signal state (e.g., signal quality parameters) of a plurality of different locations where site survey is conducted. A plurality of candidate locations where the signal strength and performance (e.g., in terms of SNR or signal strength) may be highest (e.g., top 3 or top 5) among other locations or greater than a threshold signal quality, may be selected as a plurality of candidate installation locations for the antenna device **102**. In an implementation, the smartphone (e.g., the UE **110A**) may be a C-band capable smartphone. The smartphone (e.g., the UE **110A**) may have an application **118** communicatively coupled to the central cloud server **106**. The plurality of candidate installation locations where the signal strength and performance may be greater than the threshold signal quality, may be stored locally in the application **118** as well as pushed to the central cloud server **106**. The candidate installation locations and their corresponding signal quality parameters may be stored at the central cloud server **106** as pre-deployment training information **106A**, which may be used in training of an artificial intelligence (AI) inference engine **106B**. Alternatively stated, the CPE **104** or the UE **110A** communicatively coupled to the central cloud server **106** may be configured to communicate the pre-deployment training information **106A** to the central cloud server **106**. The pre-deployment training information **106A** may comprise a signal quality state (e.g., a signal strength in decibels), a throughput rate (e.g., a download and upload speed), and other signal parameters (e.g., SNR, SINR, etc.) captured at a plurality of different locations inside or outside the building or an indoor area. In an implementation, such data may be captured at different times of day. The plurality of different locations may correspond to the plurality of candidate installation locations suitable for the antenna device **102**.

[0032] In accordance with an embodiment, the application **118** may guide where is the best location to place the CPE **104** and the antenna device **102** based on the determined plurality of candidate installation locations. In an implementation, as the central cloud server **106** may have enhanced information of environment due to serving a number of CPEs in a geographical area where the building is located, the central cloud server **106** may instruct the UE **110A** where is the most

suitable place to place the CPE **104** and the antenna device **102** at different times of day. Thereafter, the antenna device **102** may be plugged to the CPE **104**. For instance, the CPE **104** may comprise the plurality of external antenna ports **112**, where a plurality of passive patch antennas of the antenna device **102** may be detachably coupled to the plurality of external antenna ports **112** of the CPE **104** in the Snap-On configuration. One or more inbuilt antennas of the CPE **104** may be bypassed when the antenna device **102** may be detachably coupled to the CPE **104** in the Snap-On configuration. The antenna device **102** may be configured to establish an out-of-band control link (e.g., a Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) link or other personal area network link) with the CPE **104**. [0033] In accordance with an embodiment, the central cloud server **106** may be configured to select a set of parameters (e.g., an initial pan and tilt coordinates) for the antenna device **102** to orient the antenna device in an initial three-dimensional (3D) test position. The antenna device **102** may comprise the plurality of passive patch antennas distributed on a planar substrate (e.g., a printed circuit board (PCB) base material like FR4) defining a signal capture area. An example of the plurality of passive patch antennas distributed on the planar substrate is shown and described in detail, for example, in FIGS. 2A-2D. The antenna device **102** may further comprise a movable frame that supports the planar substrate on which the plurality of passive patch antennas are distributed. The antenna device **102** may further comprise one or more electric motors coupled to the movable frame, where the movement of the movable frame may be controlled by the one or more electric motors to align the plurality of passive patch antennas in different 3D position coordinates. Each of the electric motors may be a stepper motor, a servo motor, an actuator, or a combination thereof. The number of electric motors depends on the desired degree of freedom in moving the moveable frame.

[0034] The central cloud server **106** may be further configured to cause the CPE **104** and the antenna device **102** to discover a best 3D position, where an initial discovery time in the discovery operation may be about five minutes or less than five minutes. The best 3D position refers to a specific pan and tilt coordinates that ensures improved signal state of RF signal reception, for example, a higher signal strength and a higher data throughput rate as compared to other 3D positions at a given time-of-day. The antenna device **102** may then learn for 24 hours to fully complete the learning process, i.e., a training cycle after deployment and the discovery operation. After the post-deployment training cycle or learning process, the antenna device **102** may orient itself based on a time-of-day.

[0035] In accordance with an embodiment, the CPE **104** may comprise one or more processors **104B** (e.g., the application processor **116A** or the modem processor **116B**). In the initial discovery and the 24 hours training cycle, the one or more processors may be configured to acquire a plurality of RF signals captured by the plurality of passive patch antennas of the antenna device **102** via the plurality of external antenna ports **112** of the CPE **104**. In an example, the plurality of external antenna ports **112** may be SMA (Sub-Miniature version A) connectors.

[0036] In accordance with an embodiment, the one or more processors **104B** (e.g., the application processor **116A** or the modem processor **116B**) may be further configured to determine a signal quality value of each of the plurality of RF signals acquired via the plurality of external antenna ports **112**. The plurality of external antenna ports **112** may be communicatively coupled to the antenna device **102**. The one or more processors **104B** of the CPE **104** may be further configured to select at least one RF signal having a highest signal quality value from among the plurality of RF signals acquired via the plurality of external antenna ports **112** for the test 3D position. Like the signal quality value determined for the test 3D position, signal quality values (e.g., signal strength in decibels and data throughput rate) may be acquired for different 3D positions at different times of day for a given location of the antenna device **102**. Such measured values of signal quality values for different 3D positions (e.g., different pan and tilt coordinates) of the antenna device **102**, may be communicated to the CPE **104** by the antenna device **102** over the out-of-band control link. The CPE **104** may further communicate such measured values of signal quality values for different

3D positions (e.g., different pan and tilt coordinates) of the antenna device **102**, to the central cloud server **106** as post-deployment training information **106C**.

[0037] In accordance with an embodiment, the one or more processors **104B** of the CPE **104** may be further configured to dynamically combine one or more RF signals of the plurality of RF signals acquired via the plurality of external antenna ports **112**. The combined signal may be used to relay for end-user devices, such as the one or more UEs **110**. The CPE **104** may include a modem that is known in the art and may perform known CPE modem functions, for example, modulation and demodulation, cellular connection management, error correction, user's data security, and network traffic management. However, the interaction between the modem **104C** of the CPE **104** and the antenna device **102** may be done via the remote antenna driver **114**. The effect of the modem **104C** of the CPE **104** combining and adjusting the 3D positions of the antenna device **102** to maximize signal rank, RSRP, and SNR may complete in 24 hours post-deployment training cycle.

[0038] The antenna device **102** may comprise a controller configured to control a movement of the movable frame to align the plurality of passive patch antennas in a specific three-dimensional (3D) position coordinate at a given time-of-day such that a radio frequency (RF) signal receptivity by one or more passive patch antennas of the plurality of passive patch antennas in the signal capture area is increased from a first signal state to a second signal state at a first location of the antenna device **102**. The second signal state has a higher signal quality and provides higher data throughput than the first signal state. Such control of the movement of the movable frame to align the plurality of passive patch antennas in the specific 3D position coordinate may be executed based on an instruction received from the CPE **104** over the out-of-band control link. The instruction received from the CPE **104** may comprise learned information **106D** comprising a specific pan and tilt datum. The specific pan and tilt datum may be valid for a specific time period in a given time-of-day. A different instruction having another pan and tilt datum may be communicated by the CPE **104** at another time of day. In other words, the instruction received from the CPE comprises learned information that is different at different times of day. Alternatively, after the 24 hours training cycle, the antenna device **102** by itself may orient itself based on time-of-day to consistently improve the performance of the CPE **104**. The movement of the movable frame may be automatically controlled at different times of day to align the plurality of passive patch antennas in different 3D position coordinates based on learned information **106D**. Alternatively, in an implementation, instead of the instruction communicated by the CPE **104**, the instruction may be communicated by the smartphone (e.g., the UE **110A**) via the application **118** that may be communicatively coupled to the central cloud server **106**. The application **118** may be executed to monitor the performance of the CPE **104** and through the Bluetooth connection, the application **118** may control the movements of the antenna device **102** for signal capture optimization. In such a case, the smartphone (e.g., the UE **110A**) and the antenna device **102** may continue to access the central cloud server **106** but the CPE **104** may not directly send any movement commands to the external antenna, such as the antenna device **102**.

[0039] FIG. 2A is a block diagram that illustrates various components of an exemplary antenna device, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure. FIG. 2A is explained in conjunction with elements from FIGS. 1A and 1B. With reference to FIG. 2A, there is shown a block diagram **200** of the antenna device **102**. The antenna device **102** comprises a plurality of passive patch antennas **202**, a planar substrate **204**, a movable frame **206**, a base **208**, a controller **210**, one or more electric motors **212** (e.g., two or three electric motors **212** depending on the desired degree of freedom in moving the moveable frame **206**), and a battery **214**. In an implementation, the antenna device **102** may further include a plurality of antenna ports **216**, one or more indicator lights **218**, a battery charging slot **220**, a first set of switches **222**, and a radome **224**. [0040] The plurality of passive patch antennas **202** may not require any external power source to operate. The plurality of passive patch antennas **202** may be distributed on the planar substrate **204** with a defined gap among them to increase isolation. Each of the plurality of passive patch

antennas **202** may be flat, rectangular, square, or diamond shaped. The size of each of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** may be same or different. The size of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** may depend on the desired frequency range and radiation pattern. The plurality of passive patch antennas **202** may be detachably coupled to the plurality of external antenna ports **112** of the CPE **104** in the Snap-On configuration.

[0041] The planar substrate **204** may be a type of fiberglass material commonly used in printed circuit boards (PCBs), such as FR4 or other materials such as ceramic, polyimide, and Roger's substrate.

[0042] In an example, traditional patch antenna at C-Band generally require thick (costly) substrate and have limited gain. Their gain also doesn't scale in an array configuration due to surface wave and mutual coupling between antenna elements. In an implementation, the antenna device **102** may use air dielectric for virtually loss-less efficiency. Air is a good dielectric material because it has a low relative permittivity and loss tangent, which means that it is virtually loss-less, i.e., there is little energy lost as heat. This results in higher efficiency for the antenna device **102**. In an implementation, the antenna device **102** may manifest one or more of the following: a) virtually no losses therefore very high gain (>9 dBi); b) may use of thin standard FR4 material combined with Rogers **4350B** for routing low cost; c) may manifest very small coupling (<25 dB); d) no surface wave may be excited so gain scales linearly with number of the antenna elements; and d) dual polarization, high rejection (>25 dB), and broad frequency bandwidth, such as Horizontal to Vertical overall bandwidth. The dual polarization indicates that the antenna device **102** may transmit and receive signals in both horizontal and vertical polarizations. The high rejection indicates that the antenna device **102** may be capable of rejecting signals with a polarization perpendicular to the desired polarization by more than 25 dB. This means that the antenna device **102** can effectively filter out unwanted signals, resulting in a cleaner and more reliable signal. The antenna device **102** further manifest low operational temperature being passive.

[0043] The movable frame **206** may be custom, specially designed frame to support the planar substrate **204**. The movable frame **206** may be mounted on a support structure, shown, and described, for example, in FIGS. 2B, 2C, and 2D. In an example, the movable frame **206** may be complementary to the shape and size of the planar substrate **204**. The boundary or peripheral portions of the movable frame **206** may have perforations used to affix the planar substrate **204**. The movable frame **206** may move in pan and tilt motion when the electric motors **212** rotate under the control of the controller **210**.

[0044] The base **208** may support different components of the antenna device **102**. For example, the support structure may be mounted on the base **208**. In an implementation, the antenna device **102** comprises the plurality of antenna ports **216**, one or more indicator lights **218**, and the battery charging slot **220** at the base **208**.

[0045] The controller **210** may be configured to establish the out-of-band control link with the CPE **104** and control the pan and tilt movement of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202**. Examples of the controller **210** may include, but is not limited to a control circuit, a microcontroller, a microprocessor, a low-power logic circuit, or other controllers, like servo motor controllers.

[0046] The one or more electric motors **212** may be coupled to the movable frame **206**. The movement of the movable frame **206** may be controlled by the electric motors **212** to align the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in different 3D position coordinates. Each of the one or more electric motors **212** may be a stepper motor, a servo motor, an actuator, or a combination thereof.

[0047] The battery **214** may be a rechargeable battery. The battery **214** may be used to power the operations of at least the electric motors **212** and the controller **210**. Examples of the implementation of the battery **214** may include but are not limited to a lithium polymer (Lipo) battery, a Zinc-based battery, and the like.

[0048] The plurality of antenna ports **216** corresponds to the number of passive patch antennas in

the plurality of passive patch antennas **202**. In some cases, two or more passive patch antennas may be pre-combined, and in such cases, the number of passive patch antennas may be more than the number of ports of the plurality of antenna ports **216**. The plurality of antenna ports **216** may be pluggable and connected with the plurality of external antenna ports **112** via wired connectors. [0049] The one or more indicator lights **218** may indicate the power status, signal quality, an out-of-band connectivity or disconnection status with the CPE **104**, battery status, etc. of the antenna device **102**. One or more combinations of color indicators, light, and buzzers may be used to fine tune the antenna device **102**.

[0050] The battery charging slot **220** may be used to charge the battery **214**. It is observed that the antenna device **102** may be operable to about 6 months (about 200 days) considering about 5 minutes of calibration and change in alignment of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** by the one or more electric motors **212** in case the battery **214** is 3.7V, 5000 mAh, one Lipo battery. This explains the extremely low power usage by the antenna device **102**.

[0051] In an implementation, the antenna device **102** may further include the first set of switches **222**. The first set of switches **222** may be RF switches that may be configured to dynamically electrically connect or disconnect one or more passive patch antennas of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in one or more different antenna configurations. For example, three passive patch antennas may be combined in a L-shaped configuration, I-shaped configuration, or four passive patch antennas may be combined in a C-shaped configuration, o-shaped configuration, or other permutation and combination to maximize the receiving and transmitting of RF signals from outdoors-to-indoors and vice-versa at different times of day.

[0052] The radome **224** may be a protective structure that is placed over the antenna device **102** to protect the electronic components from the environment, such as rain, snow, wind, and other weather conditions.

[0053] FIG. 2B is a diagram illustrating a perspective view of the antenna device of FIG. 2A along with an unmounted planar substrate, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure. FIG. 2B is explained in conjunction with elements from FIGS. 1A, 1B, and 2A. With reference to FIG. 2B, there is shown the antenna device **102** and the planar substrate **204** unmounted from the movable frame **206** of the antenna device **102**. The plurality of passive patch antennas **202** may be distributed on the planar substrate **204**. The distribution of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** on the planar substrate **204** defines a signal capture area **226** of the antenna device **102**. The distribution of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** captures more signal power because of the improved signal capture area **226**. The size of the signal capture area **226** may be independent of the frequency of individual antenna. Thus, in higher frequency, such as in millimeter wave, there may be more individual antennas, whereas in lower frequency (94G LTE), there may be lesser individual antennas. So, the signal capture size contributes to the signal capture capability. Further, with the same size of the signal capture area **226**, as each of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** are dual polarized, the antenna device **102** uses both polarizations and combines the signal power to maximize the signal strength that is being received at the antenna device **102**, thereby improving the diversity.

[0054] The movable frame **206** provides an installation base and support for the planar substrate **204**. The size of the movable frame **206** may be complementary to that of the planar substrate **204**. The peripheral portions of the movable frame **206** may be used to affix the planar substrate **204** to the movable frame **206**.

[0055] In this embodiment, the antenna device **102** comprises the plurality of antenna ports **216**, one or more indicator lights **218**, and the battery charging slot **220** at the base **208**. The radome **224** provides a cylindrical protective covering to the various components of the antenna device **102**, especially the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** on the planar substrate **204**. The antenna device **102** may further comprise a support structure **228** on which the movable frame **206** may be mounted. The support structure **228** may move along the movable frame **206** for pan movement,

whereas the movable frame **206** may move up and down for tilt movement along a pivot point **228a** on the support structure **228**. In an implementation, the pan movement may be plus minus $\pm 80^\circ$ and the tilt (upwards and downwards movement) may be $\pm 30^\circ$. In another implementation, the pan movement may be 130-360 degrees and the tilt (upwards and downwards movement) may be $\pm 1-45^\circ$. The change in pan and tilt angles may be performed by a change in 1 degree using servo motors, such as the one or more electric motors **212**.

[0056] In another embodiment, the CPE **104** may be integrated inside the antenna servo system, for example, in the antenna device **102**. For example, the rear side of planar substrate **204** (e.g., rear side of the movable frame **206**) on which the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** are placed may have enough space or stacking PCB boards to implement the CPE functions. This type of integration may further enhance the signal capture capability where the CPE **104** and the servo-controlled antenna (i.e., the antenna device **102**) may be integrated in one box (i.e., a single-box structure) that may manifest further low loss and better performance.

[0057] FIG. 2C is a diagram illustrating a perspective view of the antenna device of FIG. 2A with mounted planar substrate along with patch antennas, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure. FIG. 2C is explained in conjunction with elements from FIGS. 1A, 1B, 2A, and 2B. With reference to FIG. 2C, there is shown the antenna device **102** with the planar substrate **204** mounted on the movable frame **206** of the antenna device **102**. There is further shown a plurality of passive patch antennas **230a**, **230b**, **230c**, and **230d** distributed on the planar substrate **204**. The plurality of passive patch antennas **230a**, **230b**, **230c**, and **230d** may correspond to the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** of FIG. 2A. The support structure **228** may be provided on the base **208**. In this implementation, the support structure **228** may comprise two arms **232A** and **232B** to hold the movable frame **208** and allow pan and tilt movement of the plurality of passive patch antennas **230a**, **230b**, **230c**, and **230d** by moving the movable frame **206**. In an implementation, each of the plurality of passive patch antennas **230a**, **230b**, **230c**, and **230d** may have different size, and may protrude from the planar substrate **204** at different protrusion heights to allow improved signal reception and diversity of RF signal capture at different angles at different 3D positions, such as different pan and tilt coordinates. In an implementation, each of the plurality of passive patch antennas **230a**, **230b**, **230c**, and **230d** may be dual-polarized patch antennas to maintain high gain and directionality.

[0058] FIG. 2D is a diagram illustrating a perspective view of the antenna device of FIG. 2A, in accordance with another exemplary embodiment of the disclosure. FIG. 2D is explained in conjunction with elements from FIGS. 1A, 1B, and 2A-2C. With reference to FIG. 2D, there is shown the antenna device **102** with the planar substrate **204** mounted on the movable frame **206** of the antenna device **102**. There is further shown a plurality of patch antennas **234a**, **234b**, **234c**, and **234d**. Two or more of the plurality of patch antennas **234a**, **234b**, **234c**, and **234d** may be connected with each other using connectors **236a**, **123b**, **236c**, and **236d** in one or more different configurations. The number of connectors **236a**, **123b**, **236c**, and **236d** may be equal to the number of the plurality of antenna ports **216**. Each of the plurality of antenna ports **216** may be connected to one corresponding connector of the connectors **236a**, **123b**, **236c**, and **236d**. The support structure **228** may comprise two arms **232A** and **232B** projected from the support structure **228** to accommodate and movably fix the movable frame **206**. There is further shown the battery **214**, which may be a rechargeable battery, to power the operations of one or more components of the antenna device **102**, such as the electric motor **212** and the controller **210** in this implementation.

[0059] FIG. 3 is a block diagram that illustrates various components of an exemplary central cloud server, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure. FIG. 3 is explained in conjunction with elements from FIGS. 1A, 1B, and 2A-2D. With reference to FIG. 3, there is shown a block diagram **300** of the central cloud server **106**. The central cloud server **106** may include a processor **302**, a primary storage **304**, an operator OSS interface **306**, and a network interface **308**. The primary storage **304** may include the pre-deployment training information **106A**,

the artificial intelligence (AI) inference engine **106B**, the post-deployment training information **106C**, and the learned information **106D** (of FIG. **1B**).

[0060] The processor **302** may be configured to obtain measured signal information associated with a plurality of candidate installation locations in or around the defined physical area, for example, a home, an enterprise, or a building, from the CPE **104**. The processor **302** may be further configured to acquire the pre-deployment training information **106A** and the post-deployment training information **106C**, which may be used in the training of the AI inference engine **106B**, to generate the output of the learned information **106D**. Examples of the implementation of the processor **302** may include but are not limited to an embedded processor, a microcontroller, a specialized digital signal processor (DSP), control circuitry, a Reduced Instruction Set Computing (RISC) processor, an Application-Specific Integrated Circuit (ASIC) processor, a Complex Instruction Set Computing (CISC) processor, and/or other processors, or state machines.

[0061] The primary storage **304** may be a datacenter, a memory, a cloud storage, a storage or disk array. The primary storage **304** may include the pre-deployment training information **106A**, the AI inference engine **106B**, the post-deployment training information **106C**, and the learned information **106D**.

[0062] The operator OSS interface **306** may be an interface to allow the external third-party systems or applications, such as the central cloud server **106**, to communicate with the Operational Support Systems (OSS) of a telecom network carrier or service provider. The OSS interface allows different parts of the OSS system to exchange data and commands with the central cloud server **106**.

[0063] The network interface **308** may be used to communicate with the CPE **104**. The network interface **308** may be a hardware component that enables the central cloud server **106** device to connect to a network to exchange data and commands.

[0064] In operation, the processor **302** may be configured to obtain a signal heatmap for different locations around a defined physical area, for example, around a building. The processor **302** may be further configured to obtain a plurality of candidate installation locations in or around the defined physical area where signal strength and data throughput rate is greater than threshold signal quality. The processor **302** may be further configured to tag each candidate installation location with corresponding one or more signal quality parameters. Example of the signal quality parameters may include but are not limited to a signal strength in decibels, SNR, SINR, and data throughput rate. The processor **302** may be further configured to store pre-deployment training information **106A** that comprises a plurality of candidate installation locations, each tagged with corresponding one or more signal quality parameters. In a site survey, a smartphone (e.g., the UE **110A** of FIG. **1B**), which may have the application **118**, may be communicatively coupled to the central cloud server **106**. The plurality of candidate installation locations where the signal strength and performance may be greater than the threshold signal quality, may be stored locally in the application **118** as well as pushed to the central cloud sever **106**.

[0065] In accordance with an embodiment, the processor **302** may be further configured to communicate guidance information to the UE **110A**, where the guidance information comprises a location coordinate in or around the physical defined area to install the CPE **104** and the antenna device **102** suitable for different times of day. Like the physical defined area, the central cloud server **106** may include measured signal information about other areas surrounding the building, i.e., the physical defined area. In an example, the central cloud server **106** may be aware of traffic information of a surrounding area of the physical defined area at different times of day over a period. The processor **302** may be further configured to determine a trend and a load associated with a serving base station, such as the RAN node **108**, which may serve the CPE **104** and indicate an average number of UEs expected to be serviced by the RAN node **108** at different times of day, one or more peak load time periods, one or more off-peak time periods. In another example, the central cloud server **106** may be aware of and may consider road information, construction

information, and traffic light information, and other signal quality influencing information, such as movable and immobile physical structures in the surrounding area. The processor **302** may be further configured to utilize such supplementary information to generate and communicate the guidance information to the UE **110A**.

[0066] In accordance with an embodiment, the processor **302** may be further configured to cause the CPE **104** and the antenna device **102** to perform a discovery operation for a defined first time period, for example, less than 5-8 minutes. The discovery operation may comprise selecting a set of parameters that comprises at least an initial pan and tilt coordinates for the antenna device **102** to orient antenna device **102** in an initial 3D test position. The discovery operation may further comprise causing the CPE **104** and antenna device **102** to discover a first 3D position for a first signal state, which may be an improved signal state (higher signal strength and higher data throughput rate) as compared to a signal state on use of the one or more inbuilt antennas **104A** by the CPE **104**.

[0067] In accordance with an embodiment, the processor **302** may be further configured to cause the CPE **104** and the antenna device **102** to perform a post deployment training operation for a defined second time period, for example, 24 hours. The post deployment training operation may also be referred to as a 24-hours learning process. In the post deployment training operation, the processor **302** may be further configured to acquire plurality of RF signals captured by plurality of passive patch antennas **202** of antenna device **102** via plurality of external antenna ports **112** of the CPE **104**. Further, the processor **302** may be further configured to determine a signal quality value of each of the plurality of RF signals acquired via the plurality of external antenna ports **112**. Further, the processor **302** may be further configured to select at least one RF signal having the highest signal quality value from among the plurality of RF signals acquired via the plurality of external antenna ports **112** for the test 3D position. The processor **302** may be further configured to obtain measured signal quality values for different 3D positions of the antenna device **102** as post-deployment training information **106C**. The signal quality values may be, for example, signal strength in decibels and data throughput rate, which may be acquired for different 3D positions (e.g., different pan and tilt coordinates) at different times of day for a given location of the antenna device **102**. The processor **302** may be further configured to dynamically combine one or more RF signals of the plurality of RF signals acquired via the plurality of external antenna ports **112**. The processor **302** may be further configured to periodically obtain modem information from the CPE **104** with regards to impact of combining and adjusting the 3D positions of the antenna device **102** to maximize signal rank, RSRP, and SNR in the defined second time period (e.g., first 24 hours after deployment) for a first location (one of the candidate installation location) of the antenna device **102**. In other words, the effect of the modem of the CPE **104** combining and adjusting the 3D positions of the antenna device **102** to maximize signal rank, RSRP, and SNR may complete in 24 hours training cycle.

[0068] In accordance with an embodiment, once the post deployment training operation for the first 24 hours after deployment, is completed, the central cloud server **106** as well as the CPE **104** becomes well aware of the signal rank, RSRP, and SNR, and data throughput rate for different times of day for different 3D positions. Thus, the processor **302** may be further configured to cause the CPE **104** to generate and communicate an instruction to the antenna device **102**. The processor **302** may be further configured to cause the CPE **104** to control a movement of the movable frame **206** to align plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in a specific 3D position coordinate in a given time-of-day such that a radio frequency (RF) signal receptivity by one or more passive patch antennas of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in the signal capture area is increased from a first signal state to a second signal state at first location of the antenna device **102**. Such control of the movement of the movable frame **206** to align the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in the specific 3D position coordinate may be executed based on the instruction communicated by the central cloud server **106** to the CPE **104** and further passed from the CPE **104** over the out-of-band

control link to the antenna device **102**. The instruction received from the CPE **104** may comprise learned information **106D** comprising a specific pan and tilt datum learned and stored in the learned information **106D**.

[0069] In accordance with an embodiment, the processor **302** may be further configured to cause the CPE **104** to update movement of the movable frame **206** to align plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in another 3D position coordinate at another time-of-day such that a radio frequency (RF) signal receptivity by one or more passive patch antennas of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in the signal capture area is increased from the second signal state to a third signal state at the first location of the antenna device **102**. This maintains the consistency of performance of the CPE **104** at different times of day.

[0070] In an implementation, for the training of the AI inference engine **106B**, the pre-deployment training information **106A** and the post-deployment training information **106C** may be used as training data. A machine learning algorithm, for example, an artificial neural network algorithm, may be used at the beginning before training with the real-world training data and parameters of the modem information as response as supervised learning labels. When the machine learning algorithm is passed through the training data, the machine learning algorithm determines patterns such that the input features (e.g. a pan datum, a tilt datum, a measured signal quality parameter, a weather condition, a UE location, a time-of-day, etc.) are mapped to the learning labels (e.g., one or more 3D positions and corresponding signal strength and data throughout greater than a threshold for a given time-of-day). The processor **302** is further configured to cause the AI inference engine **106B** to assign more weight to recent data points using, for example, an exponential time decay process. In an example, the hyperparameters of the AI inference engine **106B** may be set and tuned depending on the formulated rules, and boundaries or limits observed based on some early training. The AI inference engine **106B** may be a learned model generated as output in the training process, and thus, over a period of time, the AI inference engine **106B** is able to predict the specific 3D position most suited for a given time-of-day for a given set of input features (e.g., location, time-of-day, weather, current 3D position etc). Alternatively, in another implementation a convolutional neural network (CNN) may be used for deep learning, where the input features and their relationship with the desired output values may be derived automatically. Thus, at the end of the training phase, the learned information **106D** may be generated that specifies a plurality of time-of-day specific pan and tilt datum suited for a given installation location of the antenna device **102**.

[0071] In an implementation, in order to initiate the discovery or a search action for optimizing the 3D position of the antenna device **102**, the throughput and the bit rate or the signal strength or both may be monitored and the search action may be initiated whenever each of the throughput and the bit rate or the signal strength or both drops below corresponding level (i.e., corresponding thresholds or signal state).

[0072] FIG. **4** is a method that illustrates an exemplary method for FWA communication for high performance wireless communication, in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure. FIG. **4** is explained in conjunction with elements from FIGS. **1A**, **1B**, **2A-2D**, and **3**. With reference to FIG. **4**, there is shown a flowchart **400** comprising exemplary operations **402** to **406**. The operations **402** and **406** may be implemented in the FWA communication system **100**.

[0073] At **402**, an out-of-band control link may be established by the antenna device **102** with the CPE **104**.

[0074] At **404**, an instruction may be generated and communicated by the CPE **104** to the antenna device **102** over the out-of-band control link.

[0075] At **406**, a plurality of passive patch antennas **202** of the antenna device **102** may be aligned by the antenna device **102** in a specific 3D position coordinate at a given time-of-day such that a radio frequency (RF) signal receptivity by one or more passive patch antennas of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** may be increased from a first signal state to a second signal state at a first location of the antenna device **102**. The antenna device **102** significantly maximizes (i.e.,

improves) the signal that is being received or transmitted at the first location as compared to conventional CPEs or antenna systems.

[0076] FIGS. 5A, 5B, and 5C collectively is a flowchart illustrating an exemplary method for FWA communication for high performance wireless communication, in accordance with another embodiment of the disclosure. FIGS. 5A, 5B, and 5C are explained in conjunction with elements from FIGS. 1A, 1B, 2A-2D, and 3. With reference to FIGS. 5A, 5B, and 5C, there is shown a flowchart **500** comprising exemplary operations **502** to **518**. The operations **502** and **518** may be implemented in the central cloud server **106** of the FWA communication system **100**.

[0077] At **502**, a signal heatmap for different locations around a defined physical area may be obtained.

[0078] At **504**, a plurality of candidate installation locations in or around the defined physical area where signal strength and data throughput rate is greater than threshold signal quality may be obtained.

[0079] At **506**, each candidate installation location may be tagged with corresponding one or more signal quality parameters.

[0080] At **508**, the pre-deployment training information **106A** that may comprise a plurality of candidate installation location, each tagged with corresponding one or more signal quality parameters, may be stored, for example, at the primary storage **304**.

[0081] At **510**, guidance information may be communicated to the UE **110A**, where the guidance information may comprise a location coordinate in or around the physical defined area to install the CPE **104** and the antenna device **102** suitable for different times of day.

[0082] At **512**, the CPE **104** and the antenna device **102** may be caused to perform a discovery operation for a defined first time period, for example, less than 5-8 minutes. The discovery operation may comprise one or more operations, such as **512A** and **512B**.

[0083] At **512A**, a set of parameters that comprises at least an initial pan and tilt coordinates for the antenna device **102** may be selected to orient the antenna device **102** in an initial 3D test position.

[0084] At **512B**, the CPE **104** and the antenna device **102** may be further caused to discover a first 3D position for a first signal state.

[0085] At **514**, the CPE **104** and the antenna device **102** may be caused to perform a post deployment training operation for a defined second time period, for example, 24 hours. The post deployment training operation may also be referred to as a 24-hours learning process. The operation **514**, i.e., the post deployment training operation, may include one or more operations, such as operations **514A** to **514F**.

[0086] At **514A**, the CPE **104** may be caused to acquire a plurality of RF signals captured by plurality of passive patch antennas **202** of antenna device **102** via plurality of external antenna ports **112** of the CPE **104**.

[0087] At **514B**, the CPE **104** may be caused to determine a signal quality value of each of the plurality of RF signals acquired via the plurality of external antenna ports **112**.

[0088] At **514C**, the CPE **104** may be caused to select at least one RF signal having the highest signal quality value from among the plurality of RF signals acquired via the plurality of external antenna ports **112** for the test 3D position.

[0089] At **514D**, measured signal quality values may be obtained for different 3D positions of the antenna device **102** as post-deployment training information **106C**. The signal quality values may be, for example, signal strength in decibels and data throughput rate, which may be acquired for different 3D positions (e.g., different pan and tilt coordinates) at different times of day for a given location of the antenna device **102**.

[0090] At **514E**, one or more RF signals of the plurality of RF signals acquired via the plurality of external antenna ports **112** may be dynamically combined.

[0091] At **514F**, modem information may be periodically obtained from the CPE **104** with regards to impact of combining and adjusting the 3D positions of the antenna device **102** to maximize

signal rank, RSRP, and SNR in the defined second time period (e.g., first 24 hours after deployment) for a first location (one of the candidate installation location) of the antenna device **102**. In other words, the effect of the modem of the CPE **104** combining and adjusting the 3D positions of the antenna device **102** to maximize signal rank, RSRP, and SNR may complete in 24 hours training cycle.

[0092] At **516**, the CPE **104** may be caused to control a movement of the movable frame **206** to align plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in a specific 3D position coordinate at a given time-of-day such that a radio frequency (RF) signal receptivity by one or more passive patch antennas of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in the signal capture area is increased from a first signal state to a second signal state at first location of the antenna device **102**. Such control of the movement of the movable frame **206** to align the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in the specific 3D position coordinate may be executed based on the instruction communicated to the CPE **104** from the central cloud server **106**, which in turn further communicates the instruction to the antenna device **102** over the out-of-band control link. Alternatively, the instruction may be generated by the remote antenna driver **114** of the CPE **104**. The instruction received by the antenna device **102** may comprise learned information **106D** comprising a specific pan and tilt datum.

[0093] At **518**, the CPE **104** may be caused to update movement of the movable frame **206** to align plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in another 3D position coordinate at another time-of-day such that a radio frequency (RF) signal receptivity by one or more passive patch antennas of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in the signal capture area is increased from the second signal state to a third signal state at the first location of the antenna device **102**.

[0094] FIG. **6** is a diagram of an exemplary scenario depicting performance of a CPE at different locations around a defined physical area with and without the antenna device, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. **6** is explained in conjunction with elements from FIGS. **1A**, **1B**, **2A-2D**, **3**, **4**, and **5A-5C**. With reference to FIG. **6**, there is shown a physical-defined area **602** and a plurality of locations, such as locations **604A** to **604G**, in or around the physical-defined area **602**.

[0095] In a first example, the performance of a CPE (e.g., the CPE **104**) in terms of signal receptivity of both 4G LTE and 5G signals was tested by placing the CPE at different locations around the physical defined area **602**, such as the locations **604A** to **604G**. In this case, only internal antennas, such as the one or more inbuilt antennas **104A**, of the CPE **104** were used to capture RF signals received from a base station (e.g., the RAN node **108**) at the cell edge (e.g., in this case, the base station was almost 1.2 km away from the CPE **104**). During experimentation, the signal parameters in terms of signal strength and data throughput rate for both 4G LTE and 5G NR signals captured for the locations **604A** to **604G** when the one or more inbuilt antennas **104A** of the CPE **104** were used, are shown below in Table 1. In Table 1, there is further shown data captured (e.g., the Reference Signal Received Power (RSRP) and Ultra-wideband (UWB)) for a smartphone, such as the UE **110A**, at or near the different locations **604A** to **604G**, as reference. Typically, if such data is received during site survey, a network service provider may deny service for FWA service for Internet to an end consumer given low signal reception and low data throughput rate at the physical defined area **602**, reasoning that the end consumer is too far away from the base station (cell edge locations). The locations **1**, **2**, **3**, **4**, **5**, **6**, and **7** in the “Table 1” below correspond to the locations **602A**, **602B**, **602C**, **602D**, **602E**, **602F**, and **602G** respectively in the FIG. **6**.

TABLE-US-00001
TABLE 1
4G LTE RSRP of the UE 110A
Location
Signal
5G NR Signal
RSRP
UWB (NR)
1 -79.2 -72(NR)/60 mbps -82 Yes(weak)
2 -84.5 -81 (NR)/75 mbps -90 No
3 -91.5 -102.2 (5G NR)/25 mbps -90 Yes(weak)
4 -82 -75.8(5G NR)/36 mbps -106 Yes(weak)
5 -86.5 -107((5G NR)/90 mbps -90 Yes(weak)
6 -82 -103.5(5G NR)/55 mbps -93 No
7 -84 -79.2(5G NR)/55 mbps -104 Yes(weak)

[0096] In a second example, the performance of a CPE (e.g., the CPE **104**) in terms of signal

receptivity of both 4G LTE and 5G NR signals was tested by placing the CPE at the same locations, such as the locations **604A** to **604G**, like in the first example around the physical defined area **602**. However, in this case, the custom developed external antenna, such as the antenna device **102**, was used to capture RF signals received from the same base station as in the first example (i.e., the RAN node **108**) at the cell edge (e.g., in this case too, the base station was same 1.2 km away from the CPE **104** and the antenna device **102**). During experimentation, the signal parameters in terms of signal strength and data throughput rate for both 4G LTE and 5G NR signals were captured for the locations **604A** to **604G** when the antenna device **102** of the present disclosure was used. In Table 1, there is further shown data captured (e.g., the Reference Signal Received Power (RSRP) and Ultra-wideband (UWB)) for a smartphone, such as the UE **110A**, at or near the different locations **604A** to **604G**, as reference. It is to be observed that the 5G NR signal receptivity is increased at the locations **602A** to **602G** when the antenna device **102** was used as compared to the use of internal antennas, such as the one or more inbuilt antennas **104A** of the CPE **104**. The locations **1**, **2**, **3**, **4**, **5**, **6**, and **7** in the “Table 2” below correspond to the locations **602A**, **602B**, **602C**, **602D**, **602E**, **602F**, and **602G** respectively in the FIG. 6. However, in this case, the antenna device **102** was not automatically calibrated for different times of day in terms of movement of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** in different 3D position coordinates.

TABLE-US-00002

TABLE 2	4G LTE RSRP of the UE 110A	Location	Signal	5G NR Signal RSRP
UWB (NR) 1	-84.2	-99(NR)/90 mbps	-82 Yes(weak)	2 -80.5 -86.2 (NR)/120 mbps -90 No 3
-88.5	-88.5 (5G NR)/100 mbps	-90 Yes(weak)	4 -90 -79(5G NR)/80 mbps	-106 Yes(weak) 5
-91.2	-82((5G NR)/50 mbps	-90 Yes(weak)	6 -89.5 -101.5(5G NR)/130 mbps	-93 No 7 -87.5
-82(5G NR)/125 mbps	-104 Yes(weak)			

[0097] The improvement in the performance of the same CPE, such as the CPE **104**, for 5G NR signals can be evaluated from a comparison shown in Table 3, in an example. In the Table 3, there is shown a comparison of the performance of the CPE (e.g., the CPE **104**) in terms of signal receptivity of 5G NR signals at the same locations, such as the locations **604A** to **604G**, with the one or more inbuilt antennas **104A** versus the custom developed external antenna, such as the antenna device **102**. It is to be observed that the 5G NR signal receptivity is increased when the antenna device **102** was used as compared to the use of internal antennas, such as the one or more inbuilt antennas **104A** of the CPE **104**. The locations **1**, **2**, **3**, **4**, **5**, **6**, and **7** in the “Table 3” below correspond to the locations **602A**, **602B**, **602C**, **602D**, **602E**, **602F**, and **602G** respectively in the FIG. 6.

TABLE-US-00003

TABLE 3	CPE performance with internal antennas	CPE performance with antenna device 102
1	72(NR)/60 mbps -99(NR)/90 mbps	2 -81 (NR)/75 mbps -86.2 (NR)/120 mbps
3	-102.2 (5G NR)/25 mbps -88.5 (5G NR)/100 mbps	4 -75.8(5G NR)/36 mbps -79(5G NR)/80 mbps
5	-107(5G NR)/90 mbps -82((5G NR)/50 mbps	6 -103.5(5G NR)/55 mbps -101.5(5G NR)/130 mbps
7	-79.2(5G NR)/55 mbps -82(5G NR)/125 mbps	

[0098] In a third example, the antenna device **102** may then learn for 24 hours to fully complete the learning process, i.e., a training cycle after deployment and the discovery operation. In the Table 4, there is shown a comparison of the performance of the CPE (e.g., the CPE **104**) in terms of signal receptivity of 5G NR signals at the same locations, such as the locations **604A** to **604G**, with the one or more inbuilt antennas **104A** versus the custom developed external antenna, such as the antenna device **102**, with the adaptive and automatic movement and alignment of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** of the antenna device **102** in a specific three-dimensional (3D) position coordinate in a given time-of-day based on the instruction received from the CPE **104** based on the time-of-day. In this case, a significant and further improvement in terms of the performance of the same CPE, such as the CPE **104**, for 5G NR signals was observed with improved data throughput rate. The locations **1**, **2**, **3**, **4**, **5**, **6**, and **7** in the “Table 4” below correspond to the locations **602A**, **602B**, **602C**, **602D**, **602E**, **602F**, and **602G** respectively in the FIG. 6.

TABLE-US-00004 TABLE 4 CPE performance with external antenna, i.e., when connected to antenna device 102 with automatic CPE performance with alignment in specific 3D Location internal antennas position at a given time-of-day 1 72(NR)/60 mbps -89.5 (5G NR)/153 mbps 2 -81 (NR)/75 mbps -87.8 (5G NR)/308 mbps 3 -102.2 (5G NR)/25 mbps -91 (5G NR)/225 mbps 4 -75.8(5G NR)/36 mbps -85(5G NR)/180 mbps 5 -107(5G NR)/90 mbps -107((5G NR)/255 mbps 6 -103.5(5G NR)/55 mbps -88.2(5G NR)/210 mbps 7 -79.2(5G NR)/55 mbps -83(5G NR)/130 mbps

[0099] In a fourth example, in exemplary table 5, there is shown, in an example, the variation in data throughput rate at different times of day for one location, such as location 2 in this case for a given pan and tilt position of the antenna device **102**. Similar to location 2, at each location, the antenna device **102** learns which pan and tilt position provide comparatively higher performance in terms of signal strength and data throughput rate at different times of day in a 24 hours learning cycle.

TABLE-US-00005 TABLE 5 Data Throughput Location# Time-of-day RSRP Rate Location 2 9:00 AM-day1 -90.5 193 ... -89.8 194 ... -90 165 ... -88.2 210 ... -97 180 ... -89.2 200 ... -89 184 ... -96.5 216 ... -96.2 226 ... -88.5 208 ... -87.8 308 ... -97.8 304 ... -96.5 243 ... -89.2 193 9:00 AM-day2 -97.5 284

[0100] It is observed during experimentation that the fluctuations or changes in signal quality at different times-of-day may be attributed to dynamic nature of the environment. In contrast to the conventional FWA systems, the FWA communication system **100A** or **100B** of the present disclosure enables to improve signal quality and data throughput of the UEs, such as the one or more UEs **110**, by significantly improving the performance of the CPE **104** to which the one or more UEs **110** may be connected. The antenna device **102** employs intelligent time-of-day driven automatic alignment of the plurality of passive patch antennas to improve quality of RF signals captured from the RAN node **110** (e.g., an existing base station or an existing small cell). This time-of-day driven automatic alignment of the plurality of passive patch antennas of the antenna device **102** is observed to significantly improve the data throughput rate and improve signal receptivity (i.e., signal strength of captured RF signals) in the 5G NR communication by many fold as compared to conventional CPE or conventional FWA systems.

[0101] In an implementation, it is observed that the performance of a CPE box, such as the CPE **104**, can change up to 50% depending on the position of the CPE box. Some level of optimization may be achieved by rotating the CPE box (e.g., in pan only movement) to find the best signal reception. It is understood that end-users operating the CPE box are very unlikely to do this manually or constantly look for the best position. Thus, a pan-only servo system (e.g., using one electric motor) connected to the central cloud server **106** may be developed where any CPE box may be plugged on top of the pan-only servo system for near perfect positioning, for example, with best 3D position for enhanced signal receptivity, such as about 50% increase. This implementation may be a cost-effective and simplified implementation, which provides reasonable performance improvement although not as much as the external antenna, such as the antenna device **102**. Beneficially, it does not require any modifications to the CPE box or the involvement of the CPE manufacturers in making the product.

[0102] FIG. 7 is a diagram of an exemplary scenario of a repeater device with an integrated antenna device, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. 7 is explained in conjunction with elements from FIGS. 1A, 1B, 2A-2D, 3, 4, 5A-5C, and 6. With reference to FIG. 7, there is shown an exemplary scenario **700** that includes a repeater device **702** with a donor side **702A** and a service side **702B** (i.e., a relay side). In an implementation, the donor side **702A** and the service side **702B** (i.e., a relay side) may be implemented as a single box repeater device with one or two sides configured as donor sides and one or two other sides configured as service or relay sides. In another implementation, the repeater device **702** may be implemented as two distinct units or boxes connected with each other via wired or wireless means. In this case, the donor side **702A**

and the service side **702B** (i.e., a relay side) may be affixed on a window **704**. The repeater device **702** may use an integrated antenna device **706**. The integrated antenna device **706** may correspond to the antenna device **102** of FIGS. **1A**, **1B**, and **2A**.

[0103] In this implementation, the repeater device **702** may be used to provide outdoor-to-indoor coverage with the integrated antenna device **706**. In an example, the repeater device **702** may be a RF Digital repeater with an LTE Modem and/or a 5G modem and may support the following: high modulation (e.g., 256QAM <2% EVM), 200 MHz Bandwidth (Adjacent Channel Leakage Ratio (ACLR)>45 dB), Master Information Block (MIB) decoding, low latency digital channel filter <500 ns, potential frequency response equalization, gain control, real time downlink (DL)-uplink (UL) isolation (Oscillation) monitoring, AGC, saturation detection control for ADC, further support horizontal cum vertical polarization, MIMO, and may operate in a frequency band, such as n77 band: 3.2-4.2 GHz.

[0104] In accordance with an embodiment, the repeater device **702** may be a reconfigurable C-band repeater to support different modes of operation, such as implemented as a single-box indoor FWA device, may support single beam and multi beam antenna. In another embodiment, the repeater device **702** may be a two-box solution, i.e., one outdoor donor unit and one indoor service unit connected with a coaxial interface, or a wireless link over ISM band, or an optical interface. The repeater device **702** may configure itself as a part of a mesh network.

[0105] In an implementation, the integrated antenna device **706** may include a plurality of patch antennas, such as the plurality of passive patch antennas **202**. The integrated antenna device **706** may be a movable device, in which the plurality of patch antennas may align itself in a specific 3D position automatically based on a time-of-day like the antenna device **102**. In other words, the antenna device **102** may be integrated with the repeater device **702** to function as the integrated antenna device **706**. All the operations and functions of the antenna device **102** may be performed by the integrated antenna device **706**. By use of the integrated antenna device **706**, a gain of about ≥ 15 dBi of an RF signal **708** captured at the donor side **702A** was achieved and at the service side **702B**, a gain of about ≥ 9 dBi at each patch was achieved for relayed RF signals **710A** and **710B**. In an implementation, the plurality of patch antennas of the integrated antenna device **706** may be movable at specific 3D position at a given time-of-day only at the donor side **702B** and not at the service side **702B**. In another implementation, the plurality of patch antennas of the integrated antenna device **706** may be movable at a specific 3D position at a given time-of-day both at the donor side **702B** and the service side **702B**.

[0106] Various embodiments of the disclosure may provide a non-transitory computer-readable medium having stored thereon computer implemented instructions that when executed by a computer causes a communication system (e.g., the FWA system **100A** and **100B**) to execute operations, the operations comprising establishing an out-of-band control link by the antenna device **102** with the CPE **104**, generating and communicating an instruction by the CPE **104** to the antenna device **102** over the out-of-band control link, and aligning a plurality of passive patch antennas **202** of the antenna device **102** by the antenna device **102** in a specific 3D position coordinate at a given time-of-day such that a radio frequency (RF) signal receptivity by one or more passive patch antennas of the plurality of passive patch antennas **202** may be increased from a first signal state to a second signal state at a first location of the antenna device **102**. The antenna device **102** significantly maximizes (i.e., improves) the signal that is being received or transmitted at the first location as compared to conventional CPEs, repeaters, or antenna systems.

[0107] While various embodiments described in the present disclosure have been described above, it should be understood that they have been presented by way of example, and not limitation. It is to be understood that various changes in form and detail can be made therein without departing from the scope of the present disclosure. In addition to using hardware (e.g., within or coupled to a central processing unit ("CPU"), microprocessor, micro controller, digital signal processor, processor core, system on chip ("SOC") or any other device), implementations may also be

embodied in software (e.g., computer readable code, program code, and/or instructions disposed in any form, such as source, object, or machine language) disposed for example in a non-transitory computer-readable medium configured to store the software. Such software can enable, for example, the function, fabrication, modeling, simulation, description and/or testing of the apparatus and methods describe herein. For example, this can be accomplished through the use of general program languages (e.g., C, C++), hardware description languages (HDL) including Verilog HDL, VHDL, and so on, or other available programs. Such software can be disposed in any known non-transitory computer-readable medium, such as semiconductor, magnetic disc, or optical disc (e.g., CD-ROM, DVD-ROM, etc.). The software can also be disposed as computer data embodied in a non-transitory computer-readable transmission medium (e.g., solid state memory any other non-transitory medium including digital, optical, analog-based medium, such as removable storage media). Embodiments of the present disclosure may include methods of providing the apparatus described herein by providing software describing the apparatus and subsequently transmitting the software as a computer data signal over a communication network including the internet and intranets.

[0108] It is to be further understood that the system described herein may be included in a semiconductor intellectual property core, such as a microprocessor core (e.g., embodied in HDL) and transformed to hardware in the production of integrated circuits. Additionally, the system described herein may be embodied as a combination of hardware and software. Thus, the present disclosure should not be limited by any of the above-described exemplary embodiments but should be defined only in accordance with the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A system, comprising: an antenna device that includes: a plurality of passive patch antennas on a planar substrate, wherein the plurality of passive patch antennas is detachably coupled to a plurality of external antenna ports of a customer premise equipment (CPE), and the CPE includes a modem; a movable frame configured to support the planar substrate; and a processor configured to: control the CPE to switch connection of the modem from one or more inbuilt antennas of the CPE to the plurality of passive patch antennas in a case where the plurality of passive patch antennas is detachably coupled to the plurality of external antenna ports of the CPE; and control, based on an instruction from the CPE over an out-of-band control link, a movement of the movable frame to align the plurality of passive patch antennas in different three-dimensional (3D) position coordinates.
2. The system according to claim 1, wherein the antenna device further comprises a support structure on which the movable frame is mounted, and the support structure comprises a plurality of arms configured to move the movable frame for pan and tilt movement of the plurality of passive patch antennas.
3. The system according to claim 1, wherein the processor is further configured to control the CPE and the antenna device to execute a discovery operation for a defined first time period to discover a first 3D position for a first signal state.
4. The system according to claim 3, wherein the processor is further configured to: control the CPE and the antenna device to execute a post deployment training operation for a defined second time period, control, based on the post deployment training operation, the CPE to: acquire a plurality of RF signals captured by the plurality of passive patch antennas; determine a signal quality value of each of the plurality of RF signals; and select at least one RF signal having a highest signal quality value from among the plurality of RF signals.
5. The antenna device according to claim 1, wherein the instruction comprises learned information comprising a specific pan and tilt datum.
6. The antenna device according to claim 1, wherein the instruction comprises learned information

that is different at different times of day.

7. The antenna device according to claim 1, wherein the antenna device is configured to combine one or more RF signals of a plurality of RF signals captured via the plurality of passive patch antennas.

8. The antenna device according to claim 4, further comprising a plurality of antenna ports connected to the plurality of passive patch antennas of the antenna device, wherein the at least one RF signal having the highest signal quality value is routed from an antenna port of the plurality of antenna ports to a corresponding external antenna port of the plurality of external antenna ports of the CPE.

9. The antenna device according to claim 1, further comprising one or more electric motors that are coupled to the movable frame, wherein the one or more electric motors are configured to control the movement of the movable frame to align the plurality of passive patch antennas in the different 3D position coordinates.

10. The antenna device according to claim 9, wherein the movement of the movable frame is automatically controllable at different times of day to align the plurality of passive patch antennas in the different 3D position coordinates.

11. The antenna device according to claim 9, wherein each of the one or more electric motors is one of a stepper motor, a servo motor, an actuator, or a combination thereof.

12. A fixed wireless access (FWA) communication system, comprising: a customer premise equipment (CPE) that includes a modem; an antenna device that includes: a plurality of passive patch antennas on a planar substrate, wherein the plurality of passive patch antennas is detachably coupled to a plurality of external antenna ports of the CPE; a movable frame configured to support the planar substrate; and a processor configured to: control the CPE to switch connection of the modem from one or more inbuilt antennas of the CPE to the plurality of passive patch antennas in a case where the plurality of passive patch antennas is detachably coupled to the plurality of external antenna ports of the CPE; and control, based on an instruction from the CPE over an out-of-band control link, a movement of the movable frame to align the plurality of passive patch antennas in different three-dimensional (3D) position coordinates.

13. The FWA communication system according to claim 12, wherein the CPE comprises one or more processors configured to: acquire a plurality of RF signals captured by the plurality of passive patch antennas of the antenna device via the plurality of external antenna ports of the CPE; and determine a signal quality value of each of the plurality of RF signals acquired via the plurality of external antenna ports.

14. The FWA communication system, according to claim 13, wherein the one or more processors of the CPE are further configured to select at least one RF signal having a highest signal quality value from among the plurality of RF signals acquired via the plurality of external antenna ports.

15. The FWA communication system, according to claim 13, wherein the one or more processors of the CPE are further configured to dynamically combine one or more RF signals of the plurality of RF signals to generate a combined signal, wherein the combined signal is used to relay for end-user devices.

16. The FWA communication system, according to claim 12, wherein one or more of the plurality of passive patch antennas are dual-polarized patch antennas with orthogonal polarizations with a defined space among the plurality of passive patch antennas to minimize coupling between two polarizations and increase gain of the plurality of passive patch antennas.

17. A method of fixed wireless access communication, the method comprising: establishing, by an antenna device, an out-of-band control link with a customer premise equipment (CPE), wherein the antenna device includes: a plurality of passive patch antennas on a planar substrate, wherein the plurality of passive patch antennas is detachably coupled to a plurality of external antenna ports of the CPE, and the CPE includes a modem; a movable frame configured to support the planar substrate; controlling the CPE to switch connection of the modem from one or more inbuilt

antennas of the CPE to the plurality of passive patch antennas in a case where the plurality of passive patch antennas is detachably coupled to the plurality of external antenna ports of the CPE; communicating, by the CPE, an instruction to the antenna device over the out-of-band control link; and controlling, based on the instruction from the CPE, a movement of the movable frame to align the plurality of passive patch antennas in different three-dimensional (3D) position coordinates.
